

Chapter One

1. Understanding Civics and Ethics

1. 1. Understanding the Meaning of Civics, Ethics and Morality

1.1.1. What is Civics ?

1. Etymological

- ❖ The term civics is comes from the Latin Word ‘**civis**’ and ‘**civitas**’ that means ‘**citizen**’ and **city-state** respectively.
- The two Latin Words combine and gave birth to the subject “**Civics**”.
- Civics is a branch of Social Science, deals with the **citizens of a country**.
- Today according to the oxford dictionary **civics** is defined as a study of the **rights and duties** of Citizenship.
- **Citizenship** according to oxford dictionary a *position or status being citizen* of a particular country.

1. Rights and Duties of Citizens

a. Rights

- ✓ Rights is anything privilege or freedom protection from the state and **respected by others**.
- ❖ Rights are broadly classified into two: Moral and Legal.
- ✓ **Moral rights**: they are right which are based on the moral conscience of community. There is no legal force behind moral rights.
- ✓ **Legal Rights**: These are rights which the state recognizes and enforces. These rights protected by the state and anybody who violates them will be punished by the state.
- ✓ Legal rights are further classified into:- civil rights and political rights.

Civil Rights

- ✓ The right to get social services like health care, education, water, electricity, housing and other facilities.
- ✓ Freedom of religion;
- ✓ Prohibition of discrimination
- ✓ Freedom of speech and expression;
- ✓ Equality before law ;
- ✓ Freedom of the press;
- ✓ Freedom of movement.

Political Rights

- ❖ are rights which enable the citizens to participate in the **affairs of the state**.
- ✓ These rights are given **only to citizens**.
- ✓ Right to vote,
- ✓ Right to stand for elections,
- ✓ Freedom of peaceful assembly etc.

❖ Characteristics of rights

- ✓ Rights are not absolute or not unlimited.
- ✓ Right is universal
- ✓ Every right comes with responsibility.
- ✓ Rights may positive or negative.

b. Duties

- ❖ **Duty is an obligation.**
- ❖ **It is something that a citizen is bound to do or not to do, by law.**
- ❖ **Thus what is a right in regard to one's self is a duty in regard to others.**
- ❖ Without duties there can be no right.
- ❖ Thus **rights and duties are the two sides of the same coin.**
- ❖ Duties are classified into moral duty and legal duty.
- ❖ A duty discharged by the citizens on the basis of his **sense of morality** is called moral duty.
- ❖ There is **no legal sanction** behind it.

❖ **Legal duty** is a duty which is **recognized by law**.

❖ An individual is legally bound to perform legal duties.

❖ **Violation** of legal duty is always followed by **punishment**.

E.g.

✓ Respect the constitution and other laws of the country

✓ Respect the rights of others

✓ Pay tax

✓ Fight crime like corruption, black market drug trafficking etc.

✓ Struggle all crimes against humanities

2. “Man is a social animal” Baruch Spinoza (1632 - 1677)

- Man does not exist alone but he/she always exists with others in the world.
- Man as a social being. i.e. **whose life is closely related to each other.**
- Being social is **innate** in man.
- We need each other.

❖ *Thus, Civics concern:-*

- ✓ Understand the relationship of man and his society.
- ✓ How they can live harmoniously
- ✓ How they can resolve conflicts peacefully
- ❖ Promotes cooperation and co-existence with the existence of different idea, religion, language, culture etc... in society.

3. “Man is a political animal” Aristotle (384 BC - 322 BC)-politics

- ✓ In this Aristotle means that man lives in a more “polis”.
- ✓ Man becomes man among others, living in a society governed by **laws and customs**.
- ✓ The man develops his potential and realize its natural end in a social context.
- ✓ **No human being can escape from the deeds of politics**
- ✓ Thus, civics concerned with the study and understanding of **political institutions such as law- making institutions or legislatures (parliament), executive bodies, political parties and other various type of political institutions existing in a country.**
- ✓ How they organize, what is their powers and functions?

1.2. Origin and Development of Civic and Ethical Education

1. **Ancient Greek Civilization**: City states of Sparta and Athena.
 - ✓ Civitas are considered as citizens with full rights.
 - ✓ They thought moral education.
2. **Roman Civilization**: Citizenship education was given by religious institution due to their bond with state/ government.
3. **Renaissance period**: Churches fail to shape peoples activities and behaviors, led to the separation of civic education from religious education.
 - ✓ This period resulted in revolution in Europe and America
 - ✓ These revolutions led to the emergence of modern democracy and growth of modern secular civic education.

❖ Development of civic Education in Ethiopia

- Emperor Hailesilassie- **Moral Education** to serve the monarchical system to respect both the emperor and divine authority.
- Military Era- **Political Education** to feed the young grow up with socialist view-Marxism-Leninism ideology and dogma.
- After 1991 Ethiopia- **Civic and ethical education** as key subject to aware citizens know their rights, duties, constitution, democracy and the government system.

1.3. Goals of Civic and Ethical Education

✓ The general goal of civic and ethical education is to develop active participation of citizens. The young generation must learn the practical virtues of citizenship, which include justice, equality and fairness.

✓ **Specifically, it opt to:**

A. To enhance the culture of civic responsibilities

- ✓ Duties or responsibilities of citizens includes,
- Pay tax;
 - Respect the human democratic right of others;
 - Help the needy through voluntary service;
 - Actively participate in decision making to improve quality of government functioning;
 - To participate in election (either as voter or candidate);
etc

B. To promote the culture of tolerance

- ✓ Tolerance is **respect, acceptance difference and appreciation** of rich cultural diversity,
- ✓ Accommodation of differences.
- ✓ Tolerance is mandatory in **multi racial, multi ethnic, multicultural, and multi lingual**.
- ✓ **Cultivation of tolerance** and the eradication of negative stereotypes (and prejudice) and serves as a guarantee of peace and stability and as an obstacle to the outbreak of violence, war, conflict.

C. Open-mindedness:-

- Readiness to enter dialogue, listen to others idea and **change positions** if necessary.
- It implies **citizen's readiness to sacrifice their individual interests** and **values for the sake of promoting the collective interests of common good**.
- ✓ **Loyalty**= involves things like keeping promises or keeping ones word, keeping relationship.
- ✓ **Virtuousness**- citizen's ability to do right things at the right time at the right way for the right purposes.

1.4. Competency of Good Citizen

- ✓ This is concerned with the **capacity or ability of citizens to participate effectively in the political system.**
- ✓ There are minimum competences that are required from Citizen. These are:
 - Civic knowledge
 - Civic skills
 - Civic attitudes

❖ Civic knowledge

- ✓ Citizens need to **know** their country about the social, cultural, political, environmental, historical, and economic **conditions and realities** of the **past** and the **present** and also the **challenge and prospects** ahead of the country.
- Citizens need to know their country, its people, history, culture, resources and the like.

❖ Civic skills

- ✓ Refer to the ability that citizens require to put the **theory, in to action** being as active member of the community.
- ✓ Includes skills of **decision making**, communication, **conflict resolutions**, compromise, **persuasions, creativity** and the like.
- ✓ **Analytical and critical thinking skills, Skills of listening** and observing
- ✓ Co-operation skills, To be capable to critically examine information

❖ Civic attitude

- ✓ An attitude is the psychological response to people, society, objects, events, occurrences and circumstances; to life itself.
- ✓ Thus **Civic attitude** refers to the character, disposition, commitment, that citizens possess which is **essential to carry out their civic responsibility**.
- ✓ **Altruistic** qualities are required to help the poor and vulnerable one in the community.
- ✓ There are also **many civic attitudes** that are required from good citizens such as;
 - Tolerance/ Respect
 - Civic-mindedness
 - Responsibility
 - Self-efficacy
- ✓ **Competence= integrates knowledge + Skill+ Attitude**

1.5. Definition of Ethics, Morality and Amorality

1.5.1. What is Ethics?

❖ **Ethics** derived from Greek word -*ethos*

- ✓ The term *ethos* refer “**custom**”; “**character**” or “**way of acting**”.
- ✓ Ethics refers to standards of conduct, standards that indicate how one should behave based on **moral duties** and virtues, which themselves are derived from principles of right and wrong.
- ❖ Ethics ask a practical question like,
 - How do human persons ought to act?
 - What is a right conduct and a good life?
- ✓ This led the study of things like value, principles, beliefs and norms of the Society.

- Ethics is **guided** by values that are rationally justified.
- It is not about unquestionable rather it is a matter of basing ethical values in rational arguments.
- ✓ It determined what is good and bad, right and wrong, virtue and vice, justice, in terms of moral behavior; of what one ought to do and what one not ought to do.
- ❖ Some common examples of ethics include **loyalty, integrity, honesty, and punctuality**.
- ✓ Disclosing a client's information without permission,
- ✓ Always being late to work,
- ✓ giving wrong information to a client, etc. are some examples of breach of work ethics.

1.5.2. What is Morality?

✓ Is Latin word- **mores/mos**

✓ Both implies **custom, manner, proper behavior, character**

✓ **Principles or standards of human conduct**

➤ **Morality** can be understood as:-

behavior or activities of individual/groups according to the standards/rules that enable to distinguish them as good or bad.

Or a **principles on which one's judgments of right and wrong are based**. They are also social, cultural, or religious beliefs or values about right or wrong.

The Difference between Ethics and Morality

Ethics	Morality
✓ Ethics is generally considered standards or good and bad, right and wrong that imposed by outside group, society or profession. ✓ Subject that study morality ✓ Objective ✓ Externalism ✓ Punishment	✓ Morality refer to an individual's own principles regarding right and wrong. ✓ It is not imposed by anyone, it is what you think is good and bad personally. ✓ Content in the subject of ethics ✓ Subjectivism ✓ Internal ✓ Create sense of guilty

1.5.3. What are the definitions of immoral and amoral?

- ✓ **Immoral** means contrary to established moral principles.
- ✓ Immoral actions are corrupt, unethical, sinful, or wrong.

E.g. Stealing is immoral.

➤ **Amoral:- can have two meanings:**

1. Neither moral nor immoral, or
2. Lacking moral sensibility.

1. Amoral **neither moral nor immoral means** if it lies outside the realm of right and wrong.

E.g. Color is amoral, Reading Book, drinking a glasses of water is amoral.

- ✓ Neither can have any moral judgment applied to it. Is not a statement of morality.

2. When a **person is called lacking moral sensibility**, it means he or she has **no concern about whether an action is right or wrong**.

E.g. an infant, unlearned in what is right and wrong, someone who lacks the mental ability to understand right or wrong due to illness are amoral

1.6. Approach to Ethics

- ❖ There are **three major approach's** of Ethics
- A. Normative Ethics**= Teleological ethics(consequentialist); Deontological Ethics(non-quentialist) and Virtue ethics
- B. Non-normative Ethics** = Met ethics; Ethical absolutism/objectivism and Ethical relativism, subjectivism
- C. Applied Ethics**= Developmental ethics; Environmental ethics and Professional ethics

1.6.1. Normative Ethics (prescriptive) ethics:

- *Normative ethics* examines moral standards, **rules**, **Principles** and **producers** for **determining** what a person should do and **should not do** or that attempt to define right and wrong conduct.
- The key assumption in normative ethics is that there is **only one ultimate criterion of moral conduct**, whether it is a **single rule or a set of principles**

A. Teleological ethics(consequentialist)

- ✓ The moral rightness or wrongness of an action is determined by its outcome, consequence or end result.
- ✓ They said that “the end justifies the means” meaning the end result of an action taken as the **criteria whether an action is right or wrong**.
- ❖ There is no act is good or bad in and of itself, rather it is good or bad only in terms of its consequences.

E.g. lying, killing and theft

- ✓ An action is good if its benefits exceeds its harms
- ✓ An action is bad if its harms exceed its benefits
- ✓ According to consequentialism, correct moral conduct is determined *solely* by a cost-benefit analysis of an action's consequences.

❖ Consequentialism has **three subdivisions**:-

<i>Ethical Egoism:</i>	<i>Ethical Altruism</i>	<i>Utilitarianism</i>
An action is morally right, if the consequences of that action are more favorable than unfavorable <i>only to the <u>agent performing the action.</u></i>	<i>It</i> is a philosophy of doing things purely for the benefit of others , without expecting to get anything out of it yourself.	An action is morally right, if the consequences of that action are more favorable <u>than unfavorable to everyone.</u>

❖ There are two types of utilitarianism

Act utilitarianism

- ✓ Results or consequences **of the single act**
- ✓ Applies utility principle to each act.
- ✓ It is right if it leads to more good than harm.

❖ **Jeremy Bentham**

Rule utilitarianism

- ✓ consequences that result of following a **rule** of conduct
- ✓ Based on general rules
- ✓ It is right if it leads to more good than harm *as a rule*.

❖ **Johan Stuart Mill**

B. Deontological Ethics

- Etymologically the word deontology derived from Greek “**deontos**”: means what **obligation or duty**.
- Thus, it is sometimes called **Kantian Ethics or non-consequentialist Ethics**.
- According to Deontologists the **rightness or wrongness of an action is determined by or measured by the Reasons of Duty, Principle, Rule based ethics**.
- **Deontological ethics** says, some kinds of action are **wrong or right** in themselves, regardless of the consequences.

➤ **Under Deontological ethics** there are **four central** duty theories:

1. Duty to oneself, duty to others, rights theory
2. Categorical imperative duty
3. Prima Facie Duties.
4. Divine based duty ethics

1. Duty to oneself, duty to others, rights theory

a. Duty oneself, has two sorts:

1. Duties of the soul,
2. Duties of the body

b. Concerning our duties towards others

- ✓ Avoid wronging others,
- ✓ Treat people as equals, and
- ✓ Promote the good of others.

C. Rights theory

- ✓ John Locke, argued that we should not harm anyone's life, health, liberty or possessions. For Locke, these are our **natural rights**, given to us by God.
- ✓ **Thomas Jefferson** recognizes three foundational rights: **life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness**.
- ✓ Jefferson and others rights theorists realized that, peoples has rights of property, movement, speech, and religious expression.

2. The Categorical imperative duty

- ✓ It tells us what we ought to do.
- ✓ Actions done out of **good will**. An act of good will is done out of duty. **A morally good act is not done for any other reason, e.g. self-interest, personal preference, kindness, generosity or compassion.**

According to the Categorical imperative, if an action is right,

1. It is universalizable; in **all times** and **all places**.
2. It treats others(peoples) as an end-in-themselves, not just as a means to an end;
3. It is motivated by a sense of duty defined by the moral law.

There are two types of Imperative. These are:-

A. Categorical imperative and

B. Hypothetical imperative

Categorical Imperatives	Hypothetical Imperatives
Unconditional commands Without exceptions Universal Absolute	Conditional With exception Relative
Not motivated by need or desire “Do X”	Motivated by need or desire If you want to get more of Y, then you should do X
Tell the truth	If you want to be respected tell the truth

❖ Prima facie duties

- ✓ When conflict of duties occur or when overlap duties
- ✓ Where there is a prima facie duty to do something, there is at least a **fairly strong presumption in favor of doing it.**
- ✓ A prima facie duty is a duty that is **binding (obligatory)** other things equal, that is, **unless it is overridden or trumped by another duty or duties.**
- ❖ An example of a prima facie duty is the duty to keep promises. **"Unless stronger moral considerations override, one ought to keep a promise made."**
- ❖ Kant's theory must often say that **lying is wrong**, even it can be beneficial. Ross's theory can say that a **lie may not be wrong**, depending on the benefit (the duty of beneficence may be more stringent).

❖ **Ross's list of duties**, which he believes reflects our actual moral convictions:

1. ***Fidelity***: the duty to keep promises
2. ***Reparation***: the duty to compensate others when we harm them
3. ***Gratitude***: the duty to thank those who help us
4. ***Justice***: the duty to recognize merit
5. ***Beneficence***: the duty to improve the conditions of others
6. ***Self-improvement***: the duty to improve our virtue and intelligence
7. ***Non-maleficence***: the duty to not injure others

4. Divine based duty ethics

- ✓ Divine law is derived from eternal law
- ✓ It appears to human beings as divine commands.
- ✓ Acts are right because **God commands** them.

C. Virtue Ethics

- ✓ **Virtue ethics** is a broad term that emphasize the role of **character** rather than either doing one's duty or **acting in order to bring about good consequences**.
- ✓ i.e. Places less emphasis on learning rules, and instead stresses the importance of developing *good habits of character*, such as benevolence, fairness, justice, fidelity, no maleficence, gratitude, faithfulness, non-deceptiveness (truthfulness).
- ✓ We should avoid acquiring bad character traits, or *vices*, such as cowardice, insensibility, injustice, and vanity.
- ✓ Virtuous character attain through habits-practice/ **repetitive** moral reasoning.
- ✓ Virtues found at a mean between the two extreme character traits **Excess and deficiency**.

- ❖ Plato emphasized four virtues in particular, which were later called *cardinal virtues*: wisdom, courage, temperance and justice.
- ❖ Latter Aristotle add other important virtues: fortitude, generosity, self-respect, good temper, and sincerity.
- i. **Wisdom (prudence)** knowledge of things good and evil and of what is neither good nor evil
- ii. **Courage(fortitude):-**
 - ✓ Courage to speak your mind and insist on truth.
 - ✓ It is the discipline to act on wisely-chosen values rather than an impulse.

iii. Temperance /Self control/Moderation=

✓Self-control, not just towards material goods, but self-control harmony and good discipline always in **pleasure or pain, admiration or dislike, failure or success.**

✓**Temperance is guarded against extremes**, i.e. the ability to govern ourselves in the time of happiness or pain

✓Is the means by which we regulate or 'moderate' our **appetites** and **emotions**.

iv. Justice=Justice means respecting the rights of all persons. honesty, respect, responsibility, and tolerance.

➤ After Aristotle, medieval theologians supplemented Greek lists of virtues with three Christian ones, or theological virtues: **faith, hope, and charity.**

1.6.2. Non normative Ethics

- a. Meta ethics
- b. Ethical absolutism or objectivism
- c. Ethical Relativism and Subjectivism

a. Meta ethics (Descriptive):-

- ✓ The prefix “meta” is derived from the Greek for “beyond”.
- ❖ beyond the topics considered in normative.
- ❖ beyond nature.
- ❖ Meta ethics asks such questions as:
 1. "What is the **origin and meaning** of ethical terms, such as 'good' and 'right' and 'should'?"
 2. Is ethics is metaphysical issues concerning whether morality exists independently of humans, and Psychological issues concerning the underlying mental basis of our moral judgments and conduct.
 3. Is moral judgments are universal or relative,

Is morality Objectivism / universalism and [Relative/subjectivism](#)?

Objectivism/Universalism

- Moral **statements** are universal/objective
- Moral values are objective in a spirit-like realm or **divine commands**. i.e. the God wills all moral value into existence.
- Morality is **Absolute, eternal** i.e. never change, in time and place.
- Moral principles exist independently of cultural context of societies.
- Moral values and principles are **not culture specific**, rather common to all cultures.

Relativism/Subjectivism

- Moral **statements** are Relative/subjective
- Moral relativist assumes **morality is conventionally constructed by human beings and hence varies from society to society.**
- Morality is **not absolute, eternal**
- Morality is changeable

➤ There are two distinct forms of moral relativism.

- i. *Individual relativism*, which holds that individual people create their own moral standards.
- ii. *Cultural relativism* which maintains that morality is grounded in the approval of one's society and not simply in the preferences of individual people.

Psychological Issues in Meta ethics:-

- What motivates us to be moral Psychologically ?
- Even if I am aware of basic moral standards, such as
 - ❖ **don't kill and don't steal, this does not necessarily mean that I will be psychologically obliged to act on them.**
- “Why be moral?”
 - ❖ Are to avoid **punishment**,
 - ❖ To gain **praise**,
 - ❖ To attain **happiness**,
 - ❖ To be **dignified**, or to fit in with society

i. Egoism and Altruism

ii. Emotion and Reason

iii. Male and Female Morality

1.6.3. Issues in Applied Ethics

- Applied ethics is the branch of ethics which analyze of specific, moral and controversial issues.
- Issues like **abortion, euthanasia, capital punishment, homosexuality and environmental concerns.**
- Controversial/ethical dilemma in the sense that there are significant groups of people both for and against the issue at hand or (ethical paradox or moral dilemma) is a problem in the decision-making process between **two possible options, neither of which is absolutely acceptable from an ethical perspective.**
- ❖ Specifically we can see three applied ethics categories
 1. Developmental ethics
 2. Environmental Ethics
 3. Professional ethics

1. Developmental ethics

- Development' sounds self-evidently desirable.
- ✓ Because, despite economic growth, it is impossible to minimize the prevalence of poverty, sickness, insecurity and unhappiness.
- Why did a field of development ethics arise?
 - ❖ Rise of average incomes does not necessarily benefit ordinary and especially poor people.
 - ❖ That assumption neglects issues of equity, security, personal relationships, natural environment, identity, culture and meaningfulness.
 - ❖ Increased carbon emissions, a core feature of modern development, indirectly eventually damage people in vulnerable environments around the world.
 - ❖ Development ethics become relevant because of **arguments that better alternatives are possible compared to what has happened, and that real choices exist for the future too.**

2. Environmental Ethics

- ✓ **Conservational ethics**, practical philosophy
- ✓ **Environmental ethics** is the philosophical discipline that considers the **moral and ethical relationship of human beings to the environment**.
- ✓ Environmental ethics define as **man's moral and ethical obligations to the preservation and care of the non-human environment**.
- It make for challenging philosophical debates about man's interaction with the environment.
- ❖ **Water and air pollution, the depletion of natural resources, loss of biodiversity, destruction of ecosystems, global climate change, the morality of animal experimentation, preserving endangered species, and pollution control are all part of the environmental ethics debate.**

✓ Within the discipline of environmental ethics there are tough ethical decisions humans must consider. E.g.

i. Is it acceptable for poor farmers cut down forest to make room for farmland, even if this action harms the environment?

ii. Is it morally wrong for humans to continue to burn fossil fuels knowing that this action leads to air pollution and global climate changes?

iii. Does a mining company have a moral obligation to restore the natural environment destroyed by their mining techniques?

3. **Profession, professional and Professional Ethics**

1. **Profession**= vocation/job/occupation requiring advanced training and education. Some features **Profession are:-**

- i. **Extensive training**
- ii. **The training must involve significant intellectual component.**
- iii. **Community service:** teachers, physicians, engineers and lawyers.

2. **Professional**= is a person who belongs to a learned profession or whose occupation requires high level training and proficiency.

3. **Professional ethics**= is concerned with the moral obligations and responsibilities expected from professionals.

- ✓ Workers/ employees are expected to perform their jobs with a sense of **responsibility and professionalism.**
- ✓ Business ethics, Engineering ethics, Computer ethics, Media ethics, Bio-medical ethics, Legal ethics, Research ethics etc

1.7. Ethical principles and values of moral judgments

Why should I act ethically ?

➤ In a society wherein morality is declined, **crime**, **death**, **looting**, **instability**, **social deviance**, suicide, **gross human right violation**, **corruption** and other socio, economic and political crises will prevail.

➤ On the other hand morality consists of a set of rules, these rules not restrict our freedom but promote greater freedom and wellbeing. Following moral rules accomplish the following social benefits :

- a. Keep society from **falling** apart.
- b. **Reduce** human suffering.
- c. Promote human **flourishing**.
- d. **Resolve conflicts of interest** in just and orderly ways.
- e. Assign praise and blame, reward and punishment.

The End of Chapter one
Thank you for your Attention !